Cefotaxime (Intravenous)

FORM Powder for injection

INDICATION

a) Treatment of severe infection including meningitis where sensitivities indicate.
b) Treatment of ophthalmia neonatorum without systemic disease
c) Neonatal prophylaxis where there is documented maternal infection
d) Treatment of ophthalmia neonatorum with disseminated gonococcal disease

DOSE RANGE

a) TREATMENT OF SEVERE INFECTION INCLUDING MENINGITIS

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Neonate < 7 days	50mg/kg/dose	Every 12 hours	IV
Neonate 7 to 20 days	50mg/kg/dose	Every 8 hours	IV
Neonate 21 days – 6months	50mg/kg/dose	Every 6 hours	IV

b) TREATMENT OF OPHTHALMIA NEONATORUM WITHOUT SYSTEMIC DISEASE,
c) NEONATAL PROPHYLAXIS WHERE THERE IS DOCUMENTED MATERNAL INFECTION

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Neonate	100mg/kg	Single dose	IV

d) TREATMENT OF OPHTHALMIA NEONATORUM WITH DISSEMINATED GONOCOCCAL DISEASE

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Neonate < 7days	50mg/kg	Every 12 hours	IV
Neonate 7-21 days	50mg/kg	Every 8 hours	IV

RECONSTITUTION Reconstitute a 500mg vial with 4.7ml Water for Injection to give 500mg in 5ml Solution

DILUTION Not required

METHOD OF ADMINISTRATION May be given by slow IV bolus over 3-5 minutes

Dosage Guide:

- 500mg in 5ml
- 250mg in 2.5ml
- 25mg in 0.25ml

Neonatal

Post Natal Wards – dose banded Cefotaxime

Weight < 3.5kg Cefotaxime 125mg BD
Weight ≥ 3.5kg Cefotaxime 175mg BD

Weight <2.25kg or >7kg – use 50mg/kg BD. Not suitable for dose banding.

COMPATIBILITY

Solution compatibility	Sodium Chloride 0.45%, Sodium chloride 0.9%, Glucose 5%, Glucose 10%
Solution incompatibility	No Information
IV Line compatibility	Aciclovir, Caffeine citrate, Metronidazole, Midazolam, Morphine, TPN
IV Line incompatibility	Aminoglycoside Antibiotics, Fluconazole, Heparin, Ranitidine, Sodium Bicarbonate

THIS LIST IS NOT EXHAUSTIVE PLEASE CONTACT PHARMACY FOR FURTHER INFORMATION ON COMPATIBILITY WITH ANY MEDICINES NOT INCLUDED

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS
- See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children

FURTHER INFORMATION

- Variations in the intensity of colour of the freshly prepared solution do not indicate change in potency or safety
- Average displacement volume 0.3ml/500mg
- Extravasation risk
- May cause positive coombs test.
- Cefotaxime may be associated with reversible late-onset neutropenia and eosinophillia, particularly with high doses and/or prolonged exposure

PH 4.5 - .6.5

LICENSED STATUS Licensed for use in all ages

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines

Consult local policy if applicable

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Prepared by/Checked:	Susan Kafka/Andrew Stockton/Frances Lowrie	Approved by	WoS Neonatal Pharmacist Group
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Administer reconstituted solutions immediately.
All vials, ampoules and infusion bags are for single use only unless otherwise stated.

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice please contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department